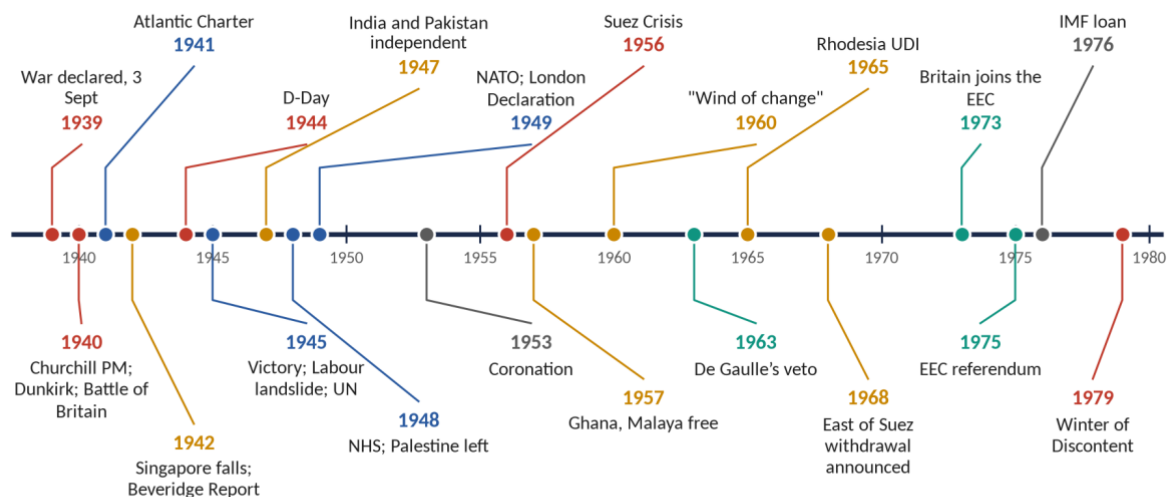


Exam-Night Revision Notes

The ten stand-alone revision sheets in one document — the whole syllabus from 1685 to 2026 for the night before the paper, with the exam plan

BRITAIN 1939–1979

red = war and crisis · blue = war, welfare and alliances · gold = empire · teal = Europe



Ten revision sheets, one per topic, each complete on its own, plus the **exam-day plan** and the **command words**.

Read one sheet in about fifteen minutes

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The Exam-Day Plan

The paper

Part	What to do
Part I · Q1	20 MCQs · 30 minutes — answer every one; where no option is right, choose " None of these ".
Part II	Four questions, two from each Section · 2 hours 30 minutes — about 35 minutes each.
Section A	Earlier British history (roughly Topics 1–7).
Section B	Modern and contemporary Britain (roughly Topics 6–10); the last question is often short notes (two of three, 10 marks each).

For every answer

- 1. Decode** the question: underline the **command word** and every **named part**.
- 2. Draw a quick answer map** (2–3 minutes): one branch per heading, taken from the question's own words.
- 3. Introduction:** define the terms and state your **thesis** in one or two sentences.
- 4. Headings and sub-headings** for every part; **dates, names and figures** in bold.
- 5. Balance:** for "assess", "how far", "critically" — both sides.
- 6. Conclusion:** answer the question directly.

Command words

Command	What it demands
Describe / give an account	What happened, in order, with detail.
Explain / why	Causes and reasons, linked and ranked.
Discuss / examine	Explain and weigh different views; conclude.
Analyse / critically	Break into parts; strengths and weaknesses; judgement.
Assess / evaluate / how far	A judgement of degree — "largely", "partly" — with evidence on both sides.
Compare / contrast	Similarities and differences, point by point.
Comment / "... quotation	Test the statement; agree, disagree or qualify.

Topic 1: The Glorious Revolution and the Later Stuarts, 1685–1714

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

This sheet is complete on its own: it can be read without the rest of the document, the night before the paper. It covers syllabus **Head I** (the Glorious Revolution; William III and Mary II; Queen Anne) and **Head III** (the Union of England and Scotland). Asked in **2015, 2018, 2019, 2021 (twice), 2023 and 2025**.

R1.1 The story in ten lines

1. **1685**: the Catholic **James II** succeeds his brother Charles II in Protestant England; he crushes **Monmouth's** rebellion at **Sedgemoor** and enlarges the army with Catholic officers.
2. **1686–87**: he uses the **dispensing power** (upheld in **Godden v Hales**, 1686), purges the Church (Compton, Magdalen College) and issues the **Declaration of Indulgence** (April 1687), suspending the laws against Catholics and Dissenters.
3. **1688**: the Declaration is reissued; the **Seven Bishops** refuse to read it and are acquitted (**30 June**); a Catholic heir is born (**10 June**); the "**Immortal Seven**" invite **William of Orange**.
4. **5 November 1688**: William lands at **Torbay**; James's officers desert; James flees to France (**December**).
5. **February 1689**: the **Convention** declares the throne vacant and offers it jointly to **William III and Mary II**, with the **Declaration of Right** (Bill of Rights, December 1689).
6. **1689–92**: war in **Scotland** (Killiecrankie, Glencoe) and **Ireland** (Derry, the **Boyne** 1690, Limerick 1691; then the Penal Laws).
7. **1689–97**: the **Nine Years' War** against Louis XIV, paid for by the **Financial Revolution** (Bank of England 1694); ended by the **Treaty of Ryswick** (1697), in which Louis recognises William.
8. **1701**: the **Act of Settlement** gives the crown after Anne to the Protestant House of **Hanover**.
9. **1702–13**: Queen Anne's **War of the Spanish Succession**: **Marlborough** wins at **Blenheim** (1704); the Tories make the **Peace of Utrecht** (1713); Britain gains **Gibraltar** and **Minorca** and becomes the leading naval and commercial power.
10. **1707**: the **Act of Union** creates the **Kingdom of Great Britain**; **1714**: Anne dies and **George I** succeeds.

R1.2 Why the Revolution happened — the causes ranked

- **Long-term:** Stuart **divine right** against Parliament; the memory of **civil war** and military rule; fierce **anti-Catholicism** (Popish Plot 1678; Exclusion Crisis 1679–81); fear of **Louis XIV's** absolutism and his persecution of Protestants (1685).
- **The main cause — James's policies:** a large army with **Catholic officers**; the **dispensing and suspending powers**; attacks on the **Church** (Ecclesiastical Commission, Magdalen); the **Declarations of Indulgence**; an attempt to **pack Parliament** to repeal the Test Acts. He alienated his natural allies, the **Tories** and the **Church**.
- **Triggers (June 1688):** the **birth of a Catholic heir** and the **acquittal of the Seven Bishops**.
- **The international cause:** William needed England against **Louis XIV**; Louis's attack on the Rhineland (September 1688) freed the Dutch to invade.
- **Verdict:** James's policies made revolution **possible**; William's invasion made it **happen**.

R1.3 Why "glorious"? — and how glorious?

- **For:** almost **bloodless in England**; done **by law** through a Convention; preserved **Protestantism** and the **ancient constitution**; ended **divine-right** monarchy; founded **constitutional monarchy**.
- **Against:** a **Dutch invasion** (revisionists); a deal among **Protestant men of property** (Hill); **not glorious in Ireland or Scotland** — the Boyne, Glencoe, the Penal Laws (Tim Harris); Catholics got nothing.
- **Historians:** **Macauley** ("of all revolutions the least violent... the most beneficent"); **Trevelyan** (glorious because bloodless); **Pincus** (the "first modern revolution").
- **Verdict:** glorious for what it **settled** — the Crown governs **with and under Parliament** — more than for how it happened.

R1.4 The Revolution Settlement, 1689–1701

Law	What it did
Bill of Rights 1689	No suspending power; no taxes or peacetime army without Parliament; free elections and speech in Parliament; no Catholic monarch
Mutiny Act 1689	Army legal for one year at a time → Parliament must meet yearly
Toleration Act 1689	Worship for Protestant Dissenters (not Catholics)
Triennial Act 1694	Elections at least every three years
Bank of England 1694	Start of the National Debt and the Financial Revolution
Civil List Act 1698	Crown's income voted by Parliament
Act of Settlement 1701	Crown to Hanover ; monarch Anglican; judges secure; no war for foreign lands without Parliament

Did not: create democracy (about one man in five could vote), cabinet government or toleration for Catholics.

R1.5 The Church after 1688 — three positions

- **Non-Jurors** (Archbishop **Sancroft**, six bishops, ~400 clergy): refused the oath; James still king by **indefeasible hereditary right**; close to the **Jacobites**.
- **High Churchmen** (Atterbury, **Sacheverell**): took the oath (William king **de facto**); defended the Church's privileges; hostile to **Dissenters**; **Tory**; Occasional Conformity Act 1711, Schism Act 1714.
- **Latitudinarians** (Tillotson, **Burnet**, Stillingfleet): welcomed the Revolution; **reason, moderation, toleration**; a broad Church; **Whig**.
- **The difference in one line:** could a revolution be lawful? Non-Jurors — no; High Church — reluctantly; Latitudinarians — yes.

R1.6 William's war and Ryswick (1689–97)

- **Causes:** Louis XIV's **Réunions** and seizure of **Strasbourg** (1681); **Revocation of the Edict of Nantes** (1685); the **League of Augsburg** (1686); Louis's attack on the Rhineland (1688); William's accession brings England in (May 1689).
- **Course:** Ireland secured (Boyne 1690); **Beachy Head** 1690 lost, **Barfleur–La Hogue** 1692 won; Flanders stalemate; **Namur** retaken 1695.
- **Ryswick (1697):** Louis **recognises William**; returns Réunions except **Strasbourg**; Lorraine restored; Dutch barrier.
- **Significance:** the Revolution secured internationally; England a **great power**; the **Financial Revolution**; but only a **truce** — Spain unresolved.

R1.7 Anne and the Spanish Succession (1702–13)

- **Cause:** **Charles II of Spain's** will (1700) left his empire to **Philip of Anjou**; Louis recognised "**James III**" (1701) → the **balance of power** at stake.
- **Anne shaped the war twice:** (1) by backing **Marlborough** and **Godolphin** — **Blenheim** 1704, **Ramillies** 1706, **Oudenarde** 1708, **Malplaquet** 1709; Gibraltar 1704, Minorca 1708; (2) by turning to the **Tories** (Sacheverell 1710; **Harley** and **St John**): Marlborough dismissed (1711), **twelve peers** created, separate peace — "**perfidious Albion**".
- **Utrecht (1713):** Philip V keeps Spain but **renounces France**; Austria gets the Spanish Netherlands and Italy; Britain gets **Gibraltar, Minorca, Newfoundland, Nova Scotia, Hudson Bay, St Kitts** and the **asiento**; France recognises the **Protestant succession**.
- **Balance of power:** France checked; Spain divided; Austria up; Dutch down; **Britain the leading naval and commercial power**; the principle written into the treaty.

R1.8 The Union of 1707

- **Background:** one king since **1603**, two parliaments.

- **Causes:** the **succession** (Act of Settlement 1701 not accepted by Scotland; Scottish **Act of Security** 1704); **war** with France (fear of a Jacobite "back door"); English **Alien Act** 1705; Scottish economic crisis — **Darien** (1698–1700) and the "ill years"; management and payments (about **£20,000**).
- **Terms:** Kingdom of **Great Britain** from **1 May 1707**; one Parliament (**45 MPs, 16 peers**); Hanoverian succession; **free trade**; the **Equivalent** (£398,085); **Scots law, courts and Kirk preserved**.
- **Consequences:** early resentment (1713 dissolution motion lost by **four** votes); **Jacobite risings** 1708, 1715, 1745; later prosperity (Glasgow tobacco; empire); a **British** identity (Colley); surviving Scottish institutions → **devolution in 1999**.

R1.9 Ten dates to write in every answer

1685 James II · **1686** Godden v Hales · **1687** Declaration of Indulgence · **10 & 30 June 1688** heir born; bishops acquitted; Invitation · **5 Nov 1688** Torbay · **1689** Bill of Rights · **1690** the Boyne · **1694** Bank of England · **1701** Act of Settlement · **1704** Blenheim · **1707** Union · **1713** Utrecht · **1714** George I.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

Between 1685 and 1714 England replaced a Catholic king who ruled by prerogative with Protestant monarchs who ruled with Parliament, paid for two great wars with a new financial system, united with Scotland, and emerged as **Great Britain** — a constitutional monarchy and a great power.

Topic 2: Hanoverian Britain, the Whig Oligarchy and the First Empire, 1714–1783

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own: it can be read the night before the paper without the rest of the document. It covers syllabus **Head II** (the Hanoverian era, the Jacobite rebellions, Walpole and the Whig oligarchy, the American War) and **Head V** (the Old Colonial System). Asked in **2015 (twice, plus a short note), 2017, 2019, 2020, 2022 and 2026**.

R2.1 The story in ten lines

1. **1714**: Anne dies; **George I** of Hanover succeeds under the Act of Settlement; the Whigs take office and the Tories are shut out for nearly fifty years.
2. **1715**: the **Fifteen** — Mar's Jacobite rising — fails at **Sheriffmuir** and **Preston**; the **Septennial Act** (1716) gives seven-year parliaments.
3. **1720**: the **South Sea Bubble** bursts; **Walpole** restores confidence and becomes first minister in **1721**.
4. **1721–42**: Walpole governs by **peace, low taxes and patronage**; the excise scheme fails (1733); he is forced into the **War of Jenkins' Ear** (1739) and falls in **1742**.
5. **1745–46**: the **Forty-Five** — Charles Edward reaches **Derby** (5 December 1745) and is destroyed at **Culloden** (16 April 1746); the clan system is dismantled.
6. **Throughout**: the empire grows on **mercantilist** rules — the **Navigation Acts**, the sugar colonies and the **Atlantic slave trade** (about 3.1 million Africans carried).
7. **1756–63**: the **Seven Years' War**. **Pitt the Elder** subsidises Prussia and strikes at French colonies; **1759** is the Year of Victories (**Quebec**, **Minden**, **Quiberon Bay**); **Plassey** (1757) wins Bengal.
8. **1763**: the **Treaty of Paris** gives Britain **Canada, Florida and dominance in India** — and leaves a debt of £133 million.
9. **1760**: **George III** succeeds, ends the Tory proscription, and the Whig oligarchy dissolves into factions; **Wilkes** raises the cry of liberty.
10. **1765–83**: **Stamp Act** → **Boston Tea Party** (1773) → **Lexington** (1775) → **Declaration of Independence** (4 July 1776) → **Saratoga** (1777) brings in France → **Yorktown** (1781) → **Treaty of Paris (1783)**: the thirteen colonies are lost.

R2.2 The Hanoverian succession — political and constitutional significance

- **Political**: the **Whig supremacy** (1714–60); the **Tories proscribed** as Jacobites; politics becomes management by patronage; **Jacobitism** as the permanent alternative (1715, 1745).

- **Constitutional:** the crown held by **Act of Parliament**, so divine right is dead; **cabinet** government grows in the king's absence; a **first minister** emerges (Walpole, 1721); ministers must hold the **Commons** (Walpole resigns 1742); the Act of Settlement ties the monarch to Britain (Anglican; no foreign wars without consent; judges secure).
- **Limits:** the Crown still chose ministers and controlled patronage — as **George III** proved after 1760. The change was by **convention**, not by statute.

R2.3 Walpole in four roles

Role	Achievement	Criticism
Minister of the Crown	Treasury and Exchequer together; kept the confidence of two kings and Queen Caroline	Depended on court favour as much as on Parliament
Prime minister	Stayed in the Commons; enforced cabinet unity; resigned on losing his majority (1742)	Never held or claimed the title; drove out able rivals
Party organiser	Patronage, the Septennial Act, Treasury management of elections	Institutionalised corruption — the "Robinocracy"
Financier	Restored credit after 1720; sinking fund; land tax down to 1s	Withdrew the sound excise scheme (1733) under pressure

R2.4 The Whig oligarchy: merits, demerits, downfall

- **Merits:** stability after a century of upheaval; peace and trade; the Protestant succession secured; cabinet government develops; practical toleration and a free press.
- **Demerits:** government by **patronage**; rotten and pocket boroughs; a closed **oligarchy** of great families; the Tories proscribed; no reform of Parliament, Ireland, the law or the colonies.
- **Downfall:** **George III** (1760) chooses his own ministers and ends the proscription; **Bute** (1762) breaks the monopoly; the Whigs split into factions; **Wilkes** and popular radicalism; the **American crisis** exposes a system built for management, not imagination.
- **Historians:** **Plumb** (stability was created by Walpole's system); **Namier** (interest and patronage, not party); **Butterfield** (ideas and party mattered).

R2.5 The Jacobites

- **The Fifteen:** Mar; **Sheriffmuir** and **Preston**; failed through poor leadership and no French help.
- **The Forty-Five:** **Glenfinnan** (Aug 1745) → **Prestonpans** → **Derby** (5 Dec) → **Falkirk** → **Culloden** (16 Apr 1746) under **Cumberland**.
- **Why Derby mattered:** no English rising, no French landing, three armies converging, only 5,000 men.
- **Aftermath:** executions; **Act of Proscription** (1746); **heritable jurisdictions abolished** (1747); forfeited estates; the clan system ends; Highland regiments later serve the empire.

- **Significance:** the dynasty made safe; Britain free to fight France overseas.

R2.6 The Old Colonial System, slavery and abolition

- **Mercantilism** → the **Navigation Acts** (1651, 1660, 1663): British ships, enumerated goods through British ports, colonial manufacture restricted.
- **Salutary neglect** before 1763: assemblies taxed themselves, smuggling was normal.
- **The triangular trade:** about **3.1 million** Africans; Liverpool, Bristol, London; the **asiento** (1713).
- **Abolition:** Somerset (1772) → Society (1787) → Equiano (1789) → **slave trade abolished 1807** → **slavery abolished 1833–34** with **£20 million** compensation to owners.
- **The debate:** **Williams** (economic decline caused abolition) v **Drescher** ("econocide" — a moral choice); resistance by the enslaved (Haiti 1791–1804, Demerara 1823, Jamaica 1831–32) was decisive.
- **Abolition and empire:** anti-slavery later justified intervention and expansion (Lagos 1861; Brussels Conference 1890) — but abolition came **before** the new imperialism, so it was a justification used afterwards, not a veil for it.

R2.7 Chatham and the Seven Years' War

- **Causes:** colonial rivalry in the **Ohio valley** and **India**; the **Diplomatic Revolution** of 1756 (Britain–Prussia, France–Austria); Frederick's invasion of Saxony.
- **Pitt's strategy:** subsidise **Prussia**, use the **navy**, promote by merit, borrow heavily — "America was conquered in Germany".
- **The victories:** **Plassey** 1757; **Louisbourg** 1758; **Quebec, Minden, Lagos, Quiberon Bay** 1759; Havana and Manila 1762.
- **Treaty of Paris 1763:** Canada, Florida, Senegal, Caribbean islands, French India reduced; Guadeloupe returned.
- **"Glorious success until 1761, then failure":** true in outline — he resigned in 1761 over Spain, took a pension and a peerage, and his 1766–68 ministry collapsed — but the same pride and independence produced both the triumph and the fall, and he still carried the repeal of the Stamp Act (1766).

R2.8 Why Britain lost America — and the balance sheet

- **Causes:** victory in 1763 removed the French threat and left a **debt**; the **Proclamation Line**; **Stamp Act** (1765), **Declaratory Act** (1766), **Townshend duties** (1767), **Tea Party** (1773), **Coercive Acts** (1774); the constitutional question of **sovereignty**; a century of self-government.
- **Why Britain lost:** distance; a popular war with no decisive centre; **loss of sea control** after France joined (1778); **no allies**; divided opinion at home; poor command.
- **Debit:** thirteen colonies; prestige; **Minorca**; debt to about £240 million; North's fall; Irish legislative independence (1782).

- **Credit:** trade recovered and grew (Adam Smith vindicated); Canada, the West Indies, Gibraltar and **India** kept; economical reform and Pitt the Younger's revival; the lesson that colonies of settlement must govern themselves; the "**swing to the East**".

R2.9 Ten dates to write in every answer

1714 George I · **1715** the Fifteen · **1716** Septennial Act · **1720** South Sea Bubble · **1721–42** Walpole · **1745–46** the Forty-Five and Culloden · **1756–63** Seven Years' War · **1757** Plassey · **1759** Year of Victories · **1763** Treaty of Paris and Proclamation Line · **1765** Stamp Act · **1773** Boston Tea Party · **1776** Declaration of Independence · **1781** Yorktown · **1783** Treaty of Paris · **1807** slave trade abolished.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

Between 1714 and 1783 a foreign dynasty and a single party gave Britain the political stability it had lacked, and that stability — with sea power, credit and the slave-worked colonies — built the greatest empire in the world; but the victory of 1763 destroyed the fear that bound the American colonies to Britain, and the attempt to tax them lost the first empire in 1783.

Topic 3: Pitt, the French Revolution, Napoleon and the Union with Ireland, 1783–1815

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Syllabus **Head IV** (Union of England and Ireland) and **Head VI** (French Revolution and Napoleonic Wars). Asked **2016, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2025 (twice)**.

R3.1 The story in eight lines

1. **1783: Pitt the Younger** PM at 24; restores finances (sinking fund 1786, lower duties, Eden Treaty), India Act 1784.
2. **1789**: the **Bastille** falls; Fox and Price welcome it; **Burke's** *Reflections* (1790) attacks it; **Paine's** *Rights of Man* (1791–92) defends it.
3. **1792**: the **London Corresponding Society** (Hardy) demands manhood suffrage; loyalists and "Church and King" mobs answer.
4. **1793**: Louis XVI executed; France declares war (**1 February**).
5. **1792–1801**: repression — Proclamation, habeas corpus suspended (1794), treason trials, **Two Acts** (1795), **Combination Acts** (1799–1800).
6. **1798**: Irish rising (Wolfe Tone; Vinegar Hill; French at Killala) → **Act of Union**, in force **1 January 1801**; Pitt resigns over Catholic Emancipation.
7. **1793–1815**: war — the **Nile** (1798), **Trafalgar** (1805), the **Peninsula** (1808–14), Russia (1812), Leipzig (1813), **Waterloo** (18 June 1815).
8. **1815: Congress of Vienna**; Britain the world power, with Malta, the Cape and Ceylon; debt £745 million; the Corn Law and post-war unrest follow.

R3.2 The influence of the Revolution on political thought

- **Burke**: tradition, prescription, gradual change → **modern conservatism**.
- **Paine**: natural rights, a republic, welfare from progressive tax → **modern radicalism**.
- **Wollstonecraft** (1792): women's rights; **Godwin** (1793): reason and anarchism.
- **Party**: Whigs split (**1794**); Tories become the party of order; "Jacobin" discredits reform until **1832**.

R3.3 The influence on society

- **Popular politics**: the LCS and the corresponding societies — working men organise (**E. P. Thompson**).

- **Loyalism:** the larger movement — associations, volunteers (400,000 by 1804), "Church and King" riots (**Dickinson**).
- **War society:** income tax (1799), food riots, mutinies (1797), bank crisis (1797), a stronger **British** identity (**Colley**).
- **Religion and culture:** evangelical revival; the Romantic poets turn from enthusiasm to conservatism.

R3.4 The measures to check the Revolution

Propaganda (Proclamation 1792; Reeves's associations; Paine outlawed) · **Trials** (Muir and Palmer 1793; Hardy, Horne Tooke, Thelwall 1794 — acquitted) · **Laws** (habeas corpus suspended 1794; **Two Acts** 1795; **Combination Acts** 1799–1800; Unlawful Societies Act 1799) · **Force** (militia, volunteers, barracks, spies) · **Ireland** (martial law 1798; Union 1801). **Verdict:** no revolution — but liberty curtailed and reform postponed a generation.

R3.5 "Panic" and the after-effects

The panic was that of the **propertied classes** (September Massacres, the regicide, invasion scares); most people were loyal. **After-effects:** Whig split and Tory dominance; repression; unions outlawed until 1824; the Union with Ireland; twenty-two years of war and debt; conservatism and radicalism defined; reform delayed to 1832 but its language created.

R3.6 The Union of 1801

- **Background:** Protestant Ascendancy; Grattan's Parliament (1782); United Irishmen (1791); rising of **1798** (~30,000 dead).
- **Pitt's reasons:** security in war; control of the Irish Parliament; Emancipation inside a Protestant UK; free trade.
- **Terms:** UK of Great Britain and Ireland; **100 MPs**; 28 peers and 4 bishops; united churches; free trade.
- **Controversies:** bought with peerages, places and £1.25 million compensation (Castlereagh, Cornwallis); Protestant patriots opposed; Catholics accepted it expecting **Emancipation** — refused by George III; Pitt resigned; granted only **1829**.
- **Impact:** nationalism becomes **Catholic** and national — Emmet, O'Connell, Young Ireland, Fenians, Home Rule, **1922**; the **Irish Question** destabilised British politics (1846, 1886, 1910).

R3.7 Britain and the Napoleonic Wars

- **Why Britain fought:** the Low Countries, the balance of power, trade, ideology.
- **Strategy:** sea power, subsidies (seven coalitions), the Peninsula, the Orders in Council.
- **Why Britain won:** **Trafalgar**; money (income tax, credit); industry; allies; **Wellington**; Napoleon's errors in Spain and Russia.
- **Vienna:** balance of power; Concert of Europe; Malta, Cape, Ceylon, Mauritius, Heligoland.

- **Impact:** cost £1,000 million; debt £745 million; the Corn Law (1815); Luddism; Peterloo and the Six Acts (1819); a century of naval supremacy.

R3.8 Dates to write in every answer

1783 Pitt · **14 Jul 1789** Bastille · **1790** Burke · **1791–92** Paine · **1792** LCS · **1 Feb 1793** war · **1794** habeas corpus suspended · **1795** Two Acts · **1798** Irish rising; the Nile · **1799** income tax; Combination Acts · **1 Jan 1801** Union · **21 Oct 1805** Trafalgar · **1808–14** Peninsula · **18 Jun 1815** Waterloo.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

The French Revolution divided Britain, frightened its rulers into repression and the Union with Ireland, and gave it the ideas of both conservatism and radicalism; the wars that followed cost a thousand million pounds and left Britain the world's only global power.

Topic 4: The Industrial and Agricultural Revolutions and the New Society

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Syllabus **Head VII**. The most-asked topic: the Industrial Revolution (2015 sn, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2026), Methodism (2015 twice, 2024, 2025 sn), Chartism (2017, 2024), the ideas (2016 sn, 2022 sn, 2025).

R4.1 The change in one paragraph

Between about **1750 and 1850** Britain changed from a country of **villages, farms and hand-work at home** (the **domestic system**) to a country of **towns, factories and machines driven by steam** (the **factory system**). Better farming fed a population that doubled; machines, coal, iron, canals and railways created the "**workshop of the world**"; and the new society produced new classes, new suffering, new protests and new ideas.

R4.2 The Agricultural Revolution

- **Old way**: open fields in strips; one field **fallow**; shared **common**.
- **Changes**: **enclosure** (about **4,000** Acts, 1750–1850); **Tull's** seed drill; **Townshend's** turnips and clover (**Norfolk four-course rotation**); **Bakewell's** breeding; **Coke** and **Arthur Young** spread the ideas.
- **Results**: much more food for a doubled population; richer landlords; cottagers lost the common and became labourers; spare workers for the factories; the Swing Riots (1830).

R4.3 Why Britain industrialised first

People (population 6m → 8.9m in 1801 → 17.9m in 1851) · **Money** (capital from land, trade, empire and slavery; banks) · **Markets** (home and empire, protected by the navy) · **Resources** (coal and iron together) · **Transport** (sea, rivers, canals from 1761, railways from 1830; no internal tolls) · **Inventions** (Darby 1709, Kay 1733, Hargreaves c.1764, Arkwright 1769, Watt 1769, Crompton 1779, Cartwright 1785) · **Stable government** after 1688 · **Nonconformists** in business. **Verdict**: no single cause — Britain had **all of them at once**.

R4.4 The effects — the four boxes

- **Economic**: factories, cotton, iron, coal; the workshop of the world (half the world's iron and cotton cloth by 1850); new **middle** and **working** classes; free trade (1846); handloom weavers ruined.

- **Social:** towns (Manchester 75,000 → 300,000, 1801–51; 1851 census: towns overtake country); slums, **cholera**; child labour; reform — **Factory Act 1833**, **Mines Act 1842**, **Ten Hours Act 1847**, **Public Health Act 1848**, Education Act 1870.
- **Political: Reform Act 1832; Chartism;** Anti-Corn Law League and repeal (1846); unions legal (1824), TUC (1868), Labour (1900); the state grows.
- **Cultural:** Methodism and chapels; Sunday schools; cheap newspapers; the "condition of England" novels (**Dickens**, **Gaskell**, **Disraeli's** "two nations"); railway time; the **Great Exhibition 1851**.
- **Debate:** optimists (**Ashton**) v pessimists (**Hobsbawm**, **Thompson**, the **Hammonds**); **Feinstein**: wages flat until the 1840s, then rising.

R4.5 Disruption or progress? — regional examples

Lancashire: handloom weavers ruined, Manchester slums (Engels) / cotton Britain's biggest export. **Yorkshire:** Luddites (1812) / Leeds and Bradford prosper. **Midlands:** Nottingham framework knitters / Birmingham rebuilt (Chamberlain, 1870s). **South Wales:** Merthyr squalor and Rising (1831) / Dowlais the world's biggest ironworks. **North-East:** dangerous pits / railways born (1825). **Glasgow:** Europe's worst slums / the world's shipyard. **Verdict:** disruption greater for the first generation (to about 1840); progress greater afterwards.

R4.6 Methodism

- **Why:** a lazy, absent Church (pluralism, non-residence); new towns and mining villages without churches.
- **How it began:** Holy Club, Oxford (1729); Wesley's conversion, "**heart strangely warmed**" (24 May 1738); open-air preaching at Kingswood, Bristol (1739, after **Whitefield**); Conference (1744); separation after Wesley's death (1791).
- **Features:** salvation for all; personal faith and holy living; **classes** of 12, societies, **circuits**, **lay preachers**, **Conference**; Charles Wesley's hymns.
- **Success:** went to the people; simple hopeful message; dignity and responsibility for the poor; brilliant organisation; Wesley's 250,000 miles and 40,000 sermons. 72,000 members by 1791.
- **Good effects:** sobriety, thrift, education (Sunday schools), leadership, anti-slavery. **Bad effects:** acceptance of poverty, narrow puritanism, emotional excess.
- **Debate:** **Halévy** — saved England from revolution; **Thompson** — "chiliasm of despair"; but Methodist preachers led unions (**George Loveless**, Tolpuddle).

R4.7 Chartism (1838–48)

- **Charter** (1838, **Lovett**): vote for all men over 21; secret ballot; no property qualification for MPs; payment of MPs; equal constituencies; annual parliaments.
- **Why millions supported it:** the "**great betrayal**" of 1832; the **New Poor Law** (1834) and the workhouse "Bastilles"; depression 1837–42 and dear bread; factory grievances; Tolpuddle; **O'Connor** and the **Northern Star**.

- **Petitions: 1839** (1.3m; Newport Rising) · **1842** (3.3m; Plug Plot) · **1848** (Kennington Common; fake names) — all rejected.
- **Why it failed:** divided leaders (moral v physical force); strong state (army, police, railways, telegraph); middle-class hostility; recovery in good years; reforms (Corn Law repeal 1846, Ten Hours 1847); Parliament refused.
- **Long-term success:** five of six points won — 1858, **1872**, 1885, **1911**, **1918**; only annual parliaments never.

R4.8 The ideas

Idea	Core	Key names	Effect
Liberalism	Individual freedom; free trade; small state	Adam Smith (1776), Cobden, Bright, Gladstone, J. S. Mill	Free trade; later New Liberalism
Utilitarianism	"Greatest happiness of the greatest number"	Bentham (1789), the Mills, Chadwick	Poor Law 1834; public health 1848
Socialism	Shared ownership; cooperation	Owen (New Lanark), Marx, Hardie	Co-ops (1844), unions, Labour (1900)
Fabianism	Socialism gradually, through Parliament	the Webbs, Shaw (1884)	LSE (1895); Labour's Clause IV (1918)

Socialism v Liberalism: on **inequality** (natural v unjust), on **social justice** (equal rights v equal conditions), on the **state** (small v large). By 1900 **New Liberals** and **Fabians** had moved towards each other — the root of the welfare state.

R4.9 Dates to write in every answer

1709 Darby · **1733** Kay · **1738** Wesley · **1761** Bridgewater Canal · **1764** jenny · **1769** Watt, Arkwright · **1776** Adam Smith · **1779** mule · **1785** power loom · **1801** census · **1811–16** Luddites · **1830** railway · **1833** Factory Act · **1834** Poor Law, Tolpuddle · **1838** Charter · **1842** Mines Act · **1847** Ten Hours · **1848** Public Health Act; last petition · **1851** Great Exhibition · **1884** Fabians.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

Britain became the first industrial nation because many favourable conditions met at once; the change made it rich and powerful but, for a generation, made working people's lives harder — and out of that hardship came Methodism, Chartism and the ideas of Liberalism, Utilitarianism and Socialism that shaped modern Britain.

Topic 5: The Age of Reform, Parties, Peel, Gladstone and Ireland

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Syllabus **Heads VIII–IX**. The most-asked topic in Section A: reform (2015, 2016, 2018, 2019, 2020), Peel (2018, 2020, 2024), Gladstone (2017, 2022), Ireland (2024), parties (2025).

R5.1 The topic in one paragraph

In **1815** Britain was governed by landowners, elected by about **500,000** men in open, corrupt elections, with **rotten boroughs** like Old Sarum and no MPs for Manchester. By **1928** every adult had an equal, secret vote and the Commons was supreme. The change came **step by step** (1832, 1867, 1884, 1918, 1928), through **pressure from outside** and **rivalry between the parties**. Peel built the Conservatives; Gladstone led the Liberals; neither solved the **Irish Question**.

R5.2 Tory Britain 1815–30

Liverpool (1812–27): Corn Law 1815; **Peterloo** (Manchester, 16 Aug 1819, ~15 dead); **Six Acts** 1819. **Liberal Tories** from 1822: **Peel** (Home Office — death penalty for 100+ crimes ended; **Metropolitan Police 1829**), **Huskisson** (tariff cuts), **Canning** (Foreign Office; PM 1827). Unions legal **1824**. **Wellington** (1828–30): Test and Corporation Acts repealed **1828**; **Catholic Emancipation 1829** after **O'Connell's** Clare election; refused reform → fell Nov 1830.

R5.3 The Great Reform Act 1832

- **Causes:** rotten boroughs; no MPs for new towns; middle-class pressure; Political Unions (Attwood); 1830 French revolution; distress; Wellington's refusal.
- **Crisis:** bill passes by **one vote** (1831); election; **Lords reject**; riots (**Bristol, Nottingham, Derby**); **Days of May**; King agrees to create peers; **7 June 1832**.
- **Terms:** **56** boroughs lost both MPs, **30** lost one; **143** seats redistributed; **£10 householders** in boroughs; Chandos clause (£50 tenants-at-will); registration. Electorate **500,000 → 813,000** (1 man in 5).
- **For:** broke the old system; middle class in; peaceful; Lords and Crown weakened; opened the door. **Against:** 4 in 5 men voteless; no ballot; landowners still ruled; workers betrayed → Chartism.
- **Consequences:** political (1867–1928; parties) and administrative (factory inspectors 1833, Poor Law Commission 1834, town councils 1835, registration 1836, public health 1848, civil service 1870).

R5.4 William IV's "era of bills and acts" (1830–37)

Reform Act **1832** · Slavery Abolition **1833** (£20m; apprenticeship to 1838) · Factory Act **1833** (inspectors) · Education grant **1833** (£20,000) · Irish Church Act **1833** · East India Charter **1833** · Poor Law **1834** · Municipal Corporations **1835** · Tithe, Marriage, Registration Acts **1836**. Constitution: King creates peers (1832); **dismisses Melbourne 1834** — the last time; Tamworth. **Why so many**: Whig majority; reformed Parliament; industrial problems; Bentham; Evangelicals.

R5.5 Peel

- **Career**: cotton family; Ireland 1812–18 ("Orange Peel"); Home Sec. 1822–30 (police 1829); Emancipation 1829; **Tamworth 1834**; PM 1834–35, **1841–46**; Corn Laws repealed and fell **1846**; died **1850**.
- **Interior**: income tax **1842** (7d over £150); tariff cuts 1842, 1845; **Bank Charter Act 1844**; Railway Act 1844; Mines Act 1842; Factory Act 1844; **Corn Law repeal 1846** (Anti-Corn Law League; Irish blight; 231 Tories against) → party split.
- **Ireland**: firmness — **Clontarf** banned 1843, O'Connell arrested; conciliation — **Devon Commission, Maynooth** (£9,000 → £26,000), **Queen's Colleges**; Famine — **maize** £100,000, relief, Corn Law repeal.
- **Exterior** (Aberdeen): entente with France (1843); Tahiti (1844); **Webster–Ashburton 1842**; **Oregon 1846**; **Nanking 1842** (Hong Kong); Afghanistan, Sind, Sikhs.
- **Methods v Liverpool, Canning, Wellington**: Liverpool = conciliator-manager; Canning = orator, divisive; Wellington = soldier, rigid. Peel = **hands-on executive**, evidence-based, appealed to the nation, **neglected his party**. Continuity: all pragmatic liberal Tories.
- **"Most liberal of conservatives..."**: liberal **means** (police, Emancipation, free trade), conservative **ends** (Church, Union, order, property, sound money). Disraeli: "organised hypocrisy". Gash: founder of modern Conservatism.

R5.6 The road to democracy

1832 middle class · **1858** no property qualification · **1867** urban workers (Disraeli; 1.4m → 2.5m) · **1872** ballot · **1883** corrupt practices · **1884** rural workers (3.1m → 5.7m) · **1885** equal single-member seats · **1911** Lords' veto ended, MPs paid · **1918** men 21, women 30 (21.4m) · **1928** women 21 (28.9m). **How**: outside pressure (Political Unions, Chartists, Reform League 1866, suffragettes), party rivalry, industry and education, liberal ideas, the First World War. **Critically**: gradual, peaceful, from above; plural voting until **1948**. **After**: 1969 age 18; 1999 Lords Act; 2025 votes-at-16 plan.

R5.7 Parties

1832–46: registration, **Carlton Club** 1832, **Reform Club** 1836, **Tamworth** 1834. **1846–67**: fluid; Peelites; **Liberal Party 6 June 1859**. **1867–86**: National Union 1867, **Central Office** **1870**, Disraeli's 1872 speeches, **Primrose League 1883**; Chamberlain's caucus, **NLF 1877**, **Midlothian 1879–80**. **1886–1900**: Liberal Unionists; Newcastle Programme 1891;

Labour (1900). **Power:** Crown → Cabinet (last dismissal 1834; Bagehot); Lords → Commons; loose MPs → whips; Parliament → voters (1868).

R5.8 Gladstone's domestic policy

- **Liberalism:** freedom, merit, equality, free trade; "**Peace, Retrenchment, Reform**".
- **Chancellor:** budgets 1853, **1860**; paper duties 1861; Savings Bank 1861.
- **First ministry 1868–74:** Irish Church **1869**; Land Act **1870**; **Education 1870**; civil service exams **1870**; **Cardwell** (purchase ended **1871**); University Tests **1871**; Trade Union Act 1871; **Ballot 1872**; Licensing 1872; **Judicature 1873**. Lost 1874: "torrent of gin and beer".
- **Second 1880–85:** Land Act **1881** (three Fs); Married Women's Property **1882**; Corrupt Practices **1883**; Reform **1884**; Redistribution **1885**.
- **Climax?** Yes — merit, equality, free trade applied everywhere. But — little social welfare; angered supporters; split 1886; New Liberalism after 1906.

R5.9 The Irish Question

- **Definition:** how to govern Catholic, rural, discontented Ireland inside the UK — **land, religion, self-government** (plus Ulster).
- **Background:** Union **1801**; Emancipation **1829**; Famine **1845–49** (1m dead, 1m emigrants); Fenians **1867**; Butt's Home Rule League **1873**; Land League **1879**; Parnell's **86 seats 1885**; Hawarden Kite.
- **Liberal policy 1886–94:** **1st Home Rule Bill 1886** — defeated **343–313** (93 Liberals against) → **Liberal Unionists**; Salisbury rules 1886–92; Pigott forgeries 1889; Parnell's fall 1890; **Newcastle Programme 1891**; **2nd bill 1893** — Commons **301–267**, Lords **419–41**; Gladstone resigns **1894**; Rosebery drops it.
- **Judgement:** principled, far-sighted, but split the party, ignored Ulster, blocked by the Lords. **After:** 1914 Act; Easter Rising 1916; Free State 1922; Good Friday 1998; Windsor Framework 2023.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

Britain became a democracy by stages rather than by revolution — the Reform Acts of 1832, 1867, 1884, 1918 and 1928 — while Peel built the modern Conservative Party, Gladstone brought classical Liberalism to its peak, and Ireland remained the one great question that reform could not answer.

Topic 6: Victorian Britain and the World

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Syllabus **Heads IX–X** (foreign affairs). Asked: Palmerston (2015 ×2, 2016), Eastern Question (2017), Crimean War (2015), Treaty of Berlin (2016 sn), Disraeli and Gladstone (2015, 2016), Splendid Isolation (2015, 2018, 2023).

R6.1 Britain's five interests

1. **Balance of power** in Europe. 2. **Command of the sea**. 3. **Trade**. 4. **The route to India** (Mediterranean, Egypt, Suez; keep Russia from the Straits). 5. **The Low Countries** (Belgium) free of any Great Power. Palmerston: "no eternal allies... **our interests are eternal**."

R6.2 Castlereagh and Canning (1815–27)

Vienna 1815: balance of power; bases (Malta, Cape, Ceylon); Quadruple Alliance; Holy Alliance "sublime mysticism and nonsense". **Congresses**: Aix 1818, Troppau 1820 (Protocol), Laibach 1821, Verona 1822 (Britain out). **State Paper 5 May 1820**: no intervention in internal affairs. **Canning**: Latin America recognised 1824–25 ("called the New World into existence", 1826); Portugal 1826; Greece — Treaty of London 1827, **Navarino** 1827. **Singapore** 1819 (Raffles, Strait of Malacca).

R6.3 Palmerston

- **Career**: Tory Secretary at War 1809–28; Canningite; **Foreign Sec. 1830–41, 1846–51**; Home Sec. 1852–55; **PM 1855–58, 1859–65**; died 1865.
- **As FM**: **Belgium** (London 1839); **Quadruple Alliance 1834**; **Mehemet Ali** — Unkiar Skelessi 1833 reversed, Acre 1840, **Straits Convention 1841**; **Opium War, Nanking 1842** (Hong Kong); Spanish Marriages 1846 (failure); 1848 — sympathy not intervention; Haynau; **Don Pacifico 1850** ("Civis Romanus sum"); dismissed Dec 1851.
- **As PM**: Crimean victory, **Paris 1856**; Arrow War, **Peking 1860**; Mutiny, 1858 Act; **Orsini** — fell 1858; **Italy** 1859–60; American Civil War (Trent, Alabama); **Poland 1863, Denmark 1864** humiliations ("meddle and muddle"); blocked reform.
- **Judgements**: *Radical and Jingo* — liberal causes + gunboats; *neither Whig nor Tory* — a Canningite patriot. *Conservative at home, liberal abroad* — broadly true; liberal only where British interests allowed. *More successful as FM than PM* — yes: shaped Europe as FM; as PM outplayed by Bismarck, no home programme.

R6.4 The Eastern Question

- **Definition:** what to do with the **declining Ottoman Empire**; rivalry of the powers — Russia (Straits, Orthodox, Slavs), Austria (Balkans), France (Holy Places, Egypt), **Britain (route to India; stop Russia)**.
- **England's attitude:** **1820–41** preserve Turkey; Navarino; Straits Convention · **1853–56** fight Russia (Crimea) · **1856–78** preserve Turkey; Berlin; opinion split (Bulgarian horrors) · **1878–1907** Egypt replaces Turkey (1882); Armenian massacres; "wrong horse"; agreement with Russia 1907 · **1908–13** Young Turks; Bosnian crisis; Balkan Wars; Grey's **London Conference**, Treaty of London 1913. **Constant aim, changing method.**

R6.5 The Crimean War

- **Background:** "sick man"; Russian aims; British fears for India route; Napoleon III's prestige; **Holy Places**; **Menshikov** 1853; Principalities occupied; Vienna Note fails; **Sinope** (30 Nov 1853); war **28 March 1854**; Aberdeen "drifted".
- **War:** **Alma** (20 Sept), **Balaklava** (25 Oct — Light Brigade), **Inkerman** (5 Nov 1854); winter; **Sevastopol** fell Sept 1855. Raglan; Russell of *The Times*; **Nightingale** at Scutari; ~21,000 British dead (~16,000 disease); Aberdeen out, Palmerston in.
- **Treaty of Paris (30 March 1856):** Black Sea **neutralised**; southern Bessarabia lost; Danube free; Principalities guaranteed; Turkey in the Concert.
- **Results:** Russia checked till **1870–71**; **Concert broken** → Italy and Germany unify; Romania 1859–61; army reform, VC, nursing; Russian serfs freed 1861; "wrong horse".

R6.6 Disraeli, Gladstone and Berlin

- **Characters:** Disraeli — romantic, witty, opportunist, imperialist, the Queen's favourite. Gladstone — devout, earnest, moralist, economist; the Queen disliked him.
- **Disraeli:** Crystal Palace 1872; **Suez shares Nov 1875** (£4m, 44%); **Empress of India 1876**; Bulgarian horrors ("coffee-house babble"); Russo-Turkish war 1877; fleet to Constantinople; **jingo** song; **San Stefano** (3 March 1878, Big Bulgaria); Salisbury Circular; **Cyprus Convention**; **Berlin** (June–July 1878): Bulgaria cut into 3; Serbia, Montenegro, Romania independent; Bosnia to Austria; Cyprus to Britain — **"Peace with Honour"**; then Afghan War, **Isandlwana 1879**.
- **Gladstone:** six Midlothian principles (peace, Concert, no entanglements, equal rights of nations, love of freedom); **Alabama 1872**; Black Sea 1871; **Majuba 1881**; **Egypt 1882** (Tel-el-Kebir); **Gordon** killed 1885; Penjdeh 1885.
- **Verdict:** prestige v principle — but in office both served the same interests.

R6.7 Empire

India: Mutiny 1857 (Meerut; greased cartridges; Delhi, Lucknow, Cawnpore) → **Government of India Act 1858**; Empress 1876; Congress 1885. **China:** Nanking 1842, Peking 1860, New Territories lease 1898 (returned 1997). **Great Game:** Anglo-Russian rivalry in **Central Asia**; Afghan wars 1839–42, 1878–80; Penjdeh 1885; ended 1907. **Scramble for Africa** (~1881–1914): causes (economic, strategic, rivalry, technology, ideas); Berlin Conference 1884–85;

Egypt, Sudan (Omdurman 1898), Nigeria, Gold Coast, Kenya, Uganda, Rhodesia; **Fashoda 1898; Boer War 1899–1902** (Jameson Raid, Kruger telegram, concentration camps, Vereeniging).

R6.8 Splendid Isolation and its end

- **Meaning:** no permanent peacetime alliances; free hands; **Salisbury** ("float lazily downstream"); phrase 1896 (Foster).
- **Why:** island + navy (**Two-Power Standard 1889**); empire and trade; balance held by Bismarck; Parliament disliked binding treaties; Crimean lesson; confidence. Exception: **Mediterranean Agreements 1887**.
- **Dangers 1890–1902:** Weltpolitik; **Kruger telegram 1896; Navy Laws 1898, 1900;** Franco-Russian alliance 1894; Russia in China; **Fashoda 1898; Venezuela 1895; Boer War** isolation.
- **How ended:** Chamberlain's German approaches fail (1898–1901); Hay–Pauncefoot 1901; **Anglo-Japanese Alliance 30 Jan 1902** (Lansdowne); **Entente Cordiale 8 April 1904** (Egypt/Morocco; Edward VII; tested at Algeiras 1906); **Anglo-Russian Convention 31 Aug 1907** (Grey; Persia, Afghanistan, Tibet) → **Triple Entente**.
- **Positive:** freedom, no wars, economy, focus on empire. **Negative:** friendless in crises, couldn't restrain Germany, over-stretch. **Opinion:** right until c.1895; detrimental after; wisely ended — but led into the blocs of 1914.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

Britain's methods changed — congresses, Palmerston's gunboats, the Crimean War, Disraeli's bold strokes, Gladstone's Concert, Salisbury's isolation, Lansdowne's and Grey's ententes — but its interests never did: the balance of power, the sea, trade and, above all, the route to India.

Topic 7: Edwardian Britain, the Great War and the Road to 1939

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Syllabus **Heads X–XI**. Asked: Edwardian Labour movement (2021), Labour's rise and achievements (2022), WWI causes and effects (2021), Kipling and British policy (2023), WWI effects and the Liberal decline (2026), Kitchener (2022 sn), foreign policy 1919–39 (2015), the League (2020).

R7.1 The Edwardian era

Edward VII 1901–10 (loosely to 1914): wealth and poverty (**Rowntree** 1901: ~28% poor in York; **Booth**); Boer War recruits unfit. **Balfour** (1902–05): Education Act 1902; **Taff Vale** 1901 (£23,000); **tariff reform** 1903 (Chamberlain) splits Conservatives. **1906**: Liberals 397, Labour 29. **Crises 1910–14** (Dangerfield): Lords, suffragettes (WSPU 1903; Davison 1913; Cat and Mouse), Great Unrest (Tonyandy 1910; dock and rail 1911; coal 1912; Triple Alliance 1914), Ulster (Carson, Covenant, Curragh 1914). **Foreign**: ententes 1904, 1907; **Dreadnought 1906**; Morocco 1905, **Agadir 1911**; military talks; naval agreement 1912; **Haldane** (BEF, Territorials 1908).

R7.2 The Liberal reforms 1906–14

Why: poverty evidence; New Liberalism (Green, Hobhouse); national efficiency; Labour threat; Lloyd George and Churchill. **Children**: school meals 1906; medical inspection 1907; Children's Act 1908. **Old**: **pensions 1908** (5s at 70). **Workers**: Trade Disputes 1906; Labour Exchanges 1909; Trade Boards 1909. **People's Budget 1909** (supertax, land taxes) → Lords reject → two elections 1910 → **Parliament Act 1911**; MPs paid £400. **National Insurance 1911** (health 4d+3d+2d; unemployment 7s for 15 weeks). **Judgement**: foundations of the welfare state, but limited.

R7.3 The Labour movement and party

Roots: New Unionism (match girls 1888, **Dock Strike 1889**); SDF 1881, Fabians 1884, **ILP 1893**; **Keir Hardie** 1892. **LRC 27 Feb 1900** (MacDonald). **Rise**: Taff Vale → unions join; **pact 1903**; **29 MPs 1906** → Labour Party; Osborne 1909 → Trade Union Act 1913; 42 MPs 1910; unions ~4m by 1914. **Significance**: independent working-class voice; pushed Liberal reforms; class politics — but still junior before 1914. **War**: Henderson in cabinet; **1918 constitution, Clause IV**; electorate tripled. **Interwar**: opposition 1922; **govt 1924** (Wheatley housing; Zinoviev); largest party 1929; **1931** split — National Govt; 52 seats. **Achievements**: **1945–51** (393 seats) — **NHS 1948**, National Insurance 1946, nationalisation, housing, **India 1947**, NATO 1949; Wilson (Open University, death penalty

abolished, equality laws); Blair (minimum wage, devolution, Good Friday, HRA); **Starmer 2024 (411 seats)**.

R7.4 Causes of the First World War

M·A·I·N: militarism (Schlieffen; **naval race**), alliances (Triple Alliance 1882 v Triple Entente 1894–1907), imperialism, nationalism (Serbia, Pan-Slavism, Alsace-Lorraine). **Crises:** Morocco 1905, Bosnia 1908, Agadir 1911, Balkan Wars 1912–13. **July 1914: Sarajevo 28 June;** blank cheque; ultimatum 23 July; Austria v Serbia 28 July; Russia mobilises; Germany v Russia 1 Aug, v France 3 Aug; **Belgium invaded; Britain 4 Aug. Why Britain:** Belgium (1839, "scrap of paper"); France (talks, 1912 naval deal); balance of power; German navy. **Historians:** Fischer, Taylor, Ferguson, Clark.

R7.5 The war and Kitchener

Mons, Marne, Ypres 1914; Gallipoli 1915; shell crisis → coalition May 1915; **conscription Jan 1916; Jutland 31 May 1916; Somme 1 July 1916** (57,470 casualties day one); **Lloyd George PM Dec 1916;** U-boats and convoys 1917; USA April 1917; Passchendaele; Balfour Declaration; Hundred Days; **Armistice 11 Nov 1918. Two wartime PMs:** Asquith, Lloyd George. **Kitchener:** Omdurman 1898, Fashoda, Boer War (blockhouses, camps), C-in-C India (Curzon), Egypt 1911–14; War Secretary Aug 1914; foresaw long war; "Your Country Needs You", New Armies; shell crisis; died **HMS Hampshire 5 June 1916. Justified?** Entry for Belgium and balance — yes; propaganda (Bryce), hatred (Kipling), blockade, secret treaties (London 1915, Sykes–Picot 1916, Balfour 1917), vengeful 1918 election — harder to justify.

R7.6 Effects on Britain

Human: ~750,000 UK dead; lost generation; flu. **Economic:** debt ×11; income tax 1s 2d → 6s; assets sold; US loans; lost markets; old industries slump; inflation. **Social:** women (munitions ~950,000; vote 1918; 1919 Act); class barriers loosened; state control; housing 1919; Fisher Act 1918. **Industrial relations:** unions 4.1m → **8.3m;** Treasury Agreement, dilution; shop stewards; **Red Clydeside;** Whitley Councils; 1919 strikes; Sankey; **Black Friday 1921;** → General Strike. **Polity:** coalitions; electorate **7.7m → 21.4m;** **Liberal split** (Asquith v LG 1916; Maurice 1918; coupon 1918); Labour's 1918 constitution, opposition 1922, govt 1924. **Debate:** Dangerfield (dying before) v **Trevor Wilson** ("rampant omnibus") v McKibbin (class and franchise).

R7.7 Peace settlement and League

Versailles 28 June 1919: Alsace-Lorraine; Polish Corridor, Danzig; colonies → mandates; Saar; Rhineland demilitarised; army 100,000, no air force, 6 battleships; **Art. 231;** reparations £6.6bn (1921); no Anschluss. Other treaties: St Germain, Neuilly, Trianon, Sèvres → Lausanne. Keynes "Carthaginian"; Foch "armistice for twenty years". **League:** 10 Jan 1920, Geneva; Assembly, Council, Secretariat, Court, ILO; **successes** Åland, Upper Silesia, Greece–Bulgaria 1925, Nansen, health, slavery; **failures** Vilna, Corfu 1923, **Manchuria 1931,** disarmament

1932–34, **Abyssinia 1935** (Hoare–Laval). **Why failed:** USA absent; no army; weak sanctions; unanimity; Britain and France selfish; Depression; dictators; tied to Versailles.

R7.8 Foreign policy 1919–39

Aims: peace, empire, trade, economy (**Ten Year Rule 1919–32**). **1919–23:** Versailles; Washington 1922 (5:5:3); Chanak 1922. **1924–29:** Dawes 1924; **Locarno 1925**; Kellogg–Briand 1928. **1929–35:** Manchuria; Disarmament Conference; Stresa; **Naval Agreement 1935** (35%). **1935–38:** Abyssinia; **Rhineland 1936**; Spain non-intervention; Chamberlain PM 1937; **Anschluss Mar 1938**; **Munich 29–30 Sept 1938** ("peace for our time"). **1939:** **Prague 15 Mar**; **guarantee to Poland 31 Mar**; conscription; **Nazi–Soviet Pact 23 Aug**; Poland 1 Sept; **war 3 Sept**. **Rearmament:** RAF, radar, Spitfire, shadow factories. **Debate:** Guilty Men v Taylor v Parker.

R7.9 At home 1918–39

Lloyd George coalition ("fit country for heroes"; Addison 1919; Geddes Axe 1922; Irish Treaty 1921); gold standard 1925; **General Strike 4–12 May 1926** → Trade Disputes Act 1927; Equal Franchise 1928; **Crash 1929**; **1931 crisis**, National Government, gold standard left; ~3m unemployed; Import Duties 1932, Ottawa; means test; **Jarrow 1936**; Mosley, Cable Street; **abdication 11 Dec 1936** → George VI.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

Between 1901 and 1939 Britain laid the foundations of the welfare state, saw Labour rise to replace the Liberals, won a world war at a ruinous cost, and tried through the League and then appeasement to preserve a peace that the dictators destroyed.

Topic 8: The Second World War, Attlee, the Cold War and the End of Empire

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Syllabus **Heads XII–XIII**. The largest topic: Commonwealth (2015, 2017, 2024 sn), decolonisation and India (2019, 2024, 2026), Suez and the Middle East (2020, 2022 sn), Churchill (2018 sn, 2022), WWII (2016 sn, 2023), Attlee (2019), Britain and the USA (2018).

R8.1 The Second World War

Causes: Versailles; Depression; Hitler's aims (Lebensraum); League's failure; appeasement; **Nazi–Soviet Pact 23 Aug 1939**; Poland invaded → war **3 Sept 1939**. **1939–41:** Phoney War; Norway; **Churchill PM 10 May 1940**; **Dunkirk** (Operation **Dynamo**, ~338,000); France falls; **Battle of Britain** (Jul–Oct 1940); **the Blitz** (~43,000 dead); Atlantic; Lend-Lease 1941. **1941–42:** Barbarossa; Atlantic Charter; Pearl Harbor; **Singapore** falls (15 Feb 1942). **1942–45:** **El Alamein**; Stalingrad; Italy; bombing; **D-Day 6 June 1944** (Overlord); Burma (Slim); **VE Day 8 May 1945**; Hiroshima, Nagasaki; VJ Aug 1945. **Home:** evacuation, rationing, women conscripted 1941, **Beveridge 1942**, Butler Act 1944. **Cost:** ~450,000 British dead; 70–85 million worldwide. **Aftermath:** UN; superpowers; Cold War; decolonisation; Britain exhausted.

R8.2 Churchill

Warrior: Cuba, India, **Omdurman 1898**, Boer War escape 1899; Admiralty 1911–15 (**Gallipoli**); Western Front 1916; war leader 1940–45 (defiance May 1940; speeches; Mediterranean strategy; Roosevelt, Stalin). **Statesman:** Liberal reformer 1908–11; Irish Treaty 1921; Chancellor 1924–29 (gold standard); warned against Hitler; conferences (Atlantic Charter, Casablanca, Tehran, Moscow percentages, Yalta, Potsdam); **Iron Curtain, Fulton 5 Mar 1946**; Zurich 1946; PM 1951–55. **Man of letters:** *River War*, *My Early Life*, *World Crisis*, *Marlborough*, *The Second World War* (6 vols), *History of the English-Speaking Peoples*; **Nobel Prize 1953**. **Critics:** Gallipoli, gold standard, India, Singapore, Bengal famine, Dresden.

R8.3 Conferences and the UN

Atlantic Charter 14 Aug 1941 (self-determination); Arcadia (Germany first; Declaration by United Nations 1 Jan 1942); **Casablanca 1943** (unconditional surrender); **Tehran 1943**; Bretton Woods, Dumbarton Oaks 1944; Moscow percentages 1944; **Yalta Feb 1945** (zones, veto, Poland); **San Francisco — Charter 26 June 1945**; UN born **24 Oct 1945**; **Potsdam**

(Attlee replaces Churchill). **UN**: General Assembly; **Security Council (5 permanent, veto: USA, USSR, UK, France, China)**; Secretariat; ICJ; ECOSOC; agencies.

R8.4 Attlee 1945–51

Problems: debt (~£21bn), sold assets, exports down, **dollar gap**; Lend-Lease ended; "financial Dunkirk"; bomb damage; **Five Giants**. **Social**: Family Allowances 1946; **National Insurance 1946**; **NHS 5 July 1948** (Bevan); **National Assistance 1948**; Butler Act; school age 15; ~**1m homes** (prefabs), New Towns 1946. **Economic**: **US loan \$3.75bn**; **Marshall Aid ~\$2.7bn**; export drive; Cripps austerity; bread rationing 1946–48; **nationalisation** — Bank of England **1946**, coal 1947, rail and electricity 1948, gas 1949, steel 1951. **Crises**: fuel 1947; convertibility 1947; **devaluation 1949 (\$4.03 → \$2.80)**; Korea; Bevan resigns 1951. **Judgement**: social triumph (Hennessy, Morgan); economic record mixed (Barnett).

R8.5 The Cold War and the USA

Iron Curtain 1946; Britain hands Greece to US → **Truman Doctrine 1947**; Marshall Plan; Dunkirk Treaty 1947; Brussels 1948; **Berlin airlift 1948–49**; **NATO 4 April 1949** (Bevin; Art. 5); A-bomb 1952, H-bomb 1957; **Korea 1950–53**; **Malaya 1948–60**; **Nassau 1962 (Polaris)**; Wilson — no troops for Vietnam; **East of Suez Jan 1968**. **Subservient?** For: Suez, nuclear dependence, bases, Libya 1986, Gulf 1991, Afghanistan, **Iraq 2003** ("I will be with you, whatever"; Chilcot 2016). Against: Suez itself, Vietnam, Heath 1973, Grenada 1983, Syria vote 2013, AIIB 2015, Iran deal 2018, Palestine recognised 2025. **Verdict**: dependent partner by choice, not servant.

R8.6 The Commonwealth

Stages: Durham Report 1839 → Dominions (Canada 1867, Australia 1901, NZ 1907, SA 1910); Rosebery 1884 "commonwealth of nations"; Smuts 1917; Irish Treaty 1921; **Balfour Declaration 1926** ("autonomous communities ... equal in status"); **Statute of Westminster 1931**; **London Declaration April 1949** (India republic; **Head of the Commonwealth**; "British" dropped) = creation of the modern Commonwealth; Ireland leaves 1949; **Secretariat 1965**; SA leaves 1961 (back 1994); Singapore 1971, **Harare 1991**, Charter 2013; Mozambique 1995, Rwanda 2009, Gabon, Togo 2022; **56 members**; Charles III Head 2022. **Differences from Empire**: power v consent; subordination v equality; London rules v self-government; Crown sovereign v symbolic Head (republics); force v free to leave; British interests v shared values; British possessions v includes non-colonies; hierarchy v multiracial.

R8.7 Decolonisation and India

Motives: economic weakness and cost; nationalism; WWII (Singapore, Atlantic Charter); **USA, USSR, UN (Res. 1514, 1960)**; Cold War (hand to moderates); Labour ideology; **Macmillan's audit 1957 and "wind of change" 3 Feb 1960**; **Macleod**; Suez; Europe; Hola 1959. **India** — **why**: Congress, Gandhi, **Quit India 1942**; League, Jinnah, **Lahore**

1940; war weakness; **INA trials, RIN mutiny 1946**; Labour; cost. **How**: Cripps 1942; Simla 1945; elections 1945–46; **Cabinet Mission 1946**; **Direct Action 16 Aug 1946**; **Attlee's statement 20 Feb 1947**; **Mountbatten**; **3 June Plan**; **Independence Act July 1947**; **14–15 Aug 1947**; Radcliffe Line; ~12–15m displaced, hundreds of thousands killed; Kashmir. **Other cases**: Malaya 1957, **Ghana 1957**, **Kenya 1963** (Mau Mau), Nigeria 1960, Aden 1967, **Rhodesia UDI 1965** → **Zimbabwe 1980**, **Hong Kong 1997**. **WWII and Cold War as triggers**; global pressures set direction, British decisions set pace.

R8.8 Palestine and Suez

Palestine: McMahon–Hussein; **Balfour 1917**; mandate; Arab revolt 1936–39; Peel 1937; **White Paper 1939**; Irgun, Lehi; **King David Hotel 22 July 1946**; Truman's 100,000; Exodus 1947; cost ~100,000 troops; to UN Feb 1947; **Res. 181 (29 Nov 1947)**; left **14–15 May 1948**; Israel; Nakba. **Suez**: 1954 agreement to leave Canal Zone (out June 1956); Nasser; Czech arms; Aswan loans withdrawn 19 July; **nationalised 26 July 1956**; **Sèvres**; Israel attacks 29 Oct; ultimatum 30 Oct; bombing 31 Oct; **Port Said landings 5–6 Nov**; US pressure — run on sterling; ceasefire 6 Nov; UNEF (Pearson); out by 22 Dec; **Eden resigns 9 Jan 1957**. **Why withdraw**: US (decisive), sterling, UN, USSR, Commonwealth, home opposition. **Results**: end of independent great-power role; special relationship rebuilt; faster decolonisation; Nasser triumphant; Eisenhower Doctrine.

R8.9 Home and Europe 1951–79

Churchill (rationing ends 1954; **coronation 2 June 1953**); Eden; **Macmillan ("never had it so good", 1957)**; Butskellism; Wilson (devaluation 1967; **Swinging London**; social reforms); Heath (**EEC 1 Jan 1973**; decimal 1971; three-day week 1974); **referendum 1975 (67%)**; **IMF 1976**; **Winter of Discontent 1978–79 (Callaghan)**; no-confidence 311–310 (28 Mar 1979). **EEC**: out of Rome 1957; EFTA 1960; applications 1961 (**de Gaulle veto 14 Jan 1963**) and 1967 (veto); joined 1973.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

Britain won the Second World War under Churchill and built the welfare state under Attlee, but — exhausted, indebted and pressed by two anti-colonial superpowers and rising nationalism — it gave up its empire for a free Commonwealth, learned at Suez that it could not act without the USA, and at last found a new role in Europe.

Topic 9: Thatcher and Major

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Syllabus **Head XIV**. Asked: Falklands (2020, 2021, 2022, 2024 sn), Europe (2018 sn, 2021, 2026), Thatcher (2016, 2024), Major (2019, 2026 sn).

R9.1 Thatcher and Thatcherism

Thatcher: Grantham 1925; Finchley; Education Sec. ("milk snatcher"); leader 1975; "Iron Lady"; **first woman PM** (Conservative) **May 1979**; won **1979, 1983, 1987**; resigned **22 Nov 1990**; died 2013. **Thatcherism** (Gamble: "**the free economy and the strong state**"): monetarism (Friedman), free markets (Hayek), low tax, privatisation, deregulation, curbing unions, smaller state, property-owning democracy, "Victorian values", law and order, strong defence, national sovereignty, conviction not consensus.

R9.2 Economic reforms

Howe 1979: income tax cut (top 83 → 60), **VAT 15%**, exchange controls ended; high interest rates → **recession 1980–81, 3m+ unemployed**; 364 economists; "**not for turning**" 1980; riots **Brixton, Toxteth** 1981; inflation 22% → <5%. **Privatisation: BT 1984, British Gas 1986** ("Tell Sid"), BA 1987, steel 1988, **water 1989**, electricity 1990; shareholders 3m → 11m; "family silver" (Macmillan). **Big Bang 1986**. **Lawson:** top tax 40% (1988); boom and bust. **Unions:** Employment Acts 1980, 1982; **ballots 1984; miners' strike Mar 1984–Mar 1985** (Scargill; Orgreave; "enemy within"); unions 13m → <10m. **Right to Buy 1980** (1m+ sold). **Poll tax** 1989–90; riot **31 Mar 1990**.

R9.3 Educational reforms and impacts

GCSE (first exams 1988). **Education Reform Act 1988** (Baker): **National Curriculum**; national tests at 7, 11, 14; Local Management of Schools; **grant-maintained (opt-out) schools; CTCs**; open enrolment; ILEA abolished; tenure ended. **Impacts — winners:** home owners, shareholders, the City, the south-east, lower inflation, school choice. **Losers:** the unemployed, mining and industrial towns, the north, the poor (inequality rose), teachers (workload, testing).

R9.4 Best post-war PM?

For: beat inflation and strikes; transformed economy; 3 elections, 11½ years; Falklands; Cold War; changed consensus (New Labour kept it). **Against:** unemployment, deindustrialisation, inequality, north–south, miners, poll tax, "no such thing as society", split party over Europe.

Historians' polls: Attlee first, Thatcher second. **Verdict:** most transformative; "best" contested.

R9.5 The Falklands War

Background: British since **1833**; Argentina's Malvinas claim (Spanish inheritance, 1816); **UN Res. 2065 (1965)**; lease-back (Ridley 1980) rejected. **Causes:** sovereignty dispute; British signals — **HMS Endurance** withdrawal (1981 Defence Review), **Nationality Act 1981**; the **junta (Galtieri)** — economic crisis, unpopularity, 150th anniversary, belief Britain wouldn't fight; South Georgia (19 Mar 1982). **Invasion 2 April 1982; Res. 502**; Carrington resigns; task force (5 April). **Why Britain fought:** self-determination of ~1,800 islanders; aggression must not pay; pride and credibility; Thatcher. **War:** South Georgia (25 Apr); **Belgrano** (2 May, 323 dead); **Sheffield** (4 May); **San Carlos** (21 May); **Goose Green** (28 May); Sir Galahad (8 June); **surrender at Stanley 14 June 1982**. Dead: **255** British, **649** Argentine, 3 islanders. **Results:** Galtieri out; Argentine democracy 1983; "Falklands factor" → 1983 landslide; Franks Report; citizenship 1983; Mount Pleasant. **Latin America:** relations with Argentina broken **1982–90** (Madrid 1990, "sovereignty umbrella"); claim in **1994 constitution**; Kirchner tensions; **2013 referendum 99.8%**; Milei friendlier; region backed Argentina (OAS; Mercosur port ban 2011); **Chile** helped Britain.

R9.6 John Major

Domestic: Council Tax 1993; Citizen's Charter 1991; rail privatisation; Lottery 1994; polytechnics → universities 1992; "Back to Basics". **1992 win (336 seats, majority 21, 14m votes)**: Major likeable, soapbox; poll tax gone; "**Tax Bombshell**"; Kinnock's Sheffield rally; *The Sun*; trust on economy. **1997 loss (Lab 418, Con 165): Black Wednesday 16 Sept 1992** (ERM exit; competence lost); tax rises (VAT on fuel); **Europe** — Maastricht rebels, "bastards", "put up or shut up" 1995 (Redwood); **sleaze** — cash for questions, Aitken; BSE 1996; **New Labour** — Blair, Clause IV 1995, *Sun* switch; 18 years; tactical voting. **Foreign:** **Gulf War 1991** (45,000; safe havens); **Maastricht opt-outs** ("game, set and match"); "heart of Europe"; Black Wednesday; beef war; **Bosnia** (UNPROFOR; Dayton 1995); **Downing Street Declaration 1993**, **IRA ceasefire 1994**; Clinton tensions; Yeltsin; Hong Kong (Patten).

R9.7 Britain and Europe

Contribution: Churchill Zurich 1946; Brussels Treaty, NATO; **Council of Europe 1949**; **ECHR 1950**; WEU 1954. **Out:** ECSC 1951, **Rome 1957**; **EFTA 1960**; vetoes 1963, 1967. **In: 1 Jan 1973**; referendum 1975 (67%). **As member: rebate 1984**; **Single European Act 1986** (single market — **Cockfield**); enlargement; **Bruges 1988**; ERM 1990–92. **Maastricht** (1991–92; **EU 1 Nov 1993**): EMU, CFSP, JHA, citizenship; **opt-outs** euro and Social Chapter; subsidiarity; ratification crisis, confidence vote July 1993. **Euro:** Black Wednesday; **Brown's five tests 1997**; rejected 2003. **To Brexit:** 2004 enlargement and migration; Lisbon; UKIP; Bloomberg 2013; **23 June 2016 (51.9% Leave)**; left **31 Jan 2020**; TCA; Windsor Framework 2023; **reset May 2025**. **Foreign-policy impact:** Europe replaced empire;

bridge to the USA; pooled trade; CFSP; awkward partner; "Global Britain", AUKUS. **Politics:** party splits (SDP 1981; Conservatives 1990s, 2016–19); PMs brought down (Thatcher, Cameron, May); UKIP/Reform; referendums; Factortame 1990. **Identity:** "British not European"; sovereignty; Scotland and NI Remain; age and place divides; immigration.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

Thatcher broke the post-war consensus and remade Britain on free-market lines, won the Falklands and helped end the Cold War, but divided the nation; Major held on in 1992, but Black Wednesday, sleaze and above all Europe — the question that ran from Maastricht to Brexit — destroyed the Conservatives in 1997.

Topic 10: Blair to Burnham

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Asked: War on Terror (2021, 2023, 2026 sn), New Labour (2025, 2026), financial crisis (2023, 2025), Cameron (2016; reforms sn 2024, 2025), Brexit (2017), Diana (sn 2018, 2026).

R10.1 New Labour

Making: four defeats; Kinnock, Smith; **Blair leader 1994; Clause IV 1995; Third Way** (Giddens). **Elections:** 1997 (**418**), 2001 (413), 2005 (355). **Economy:** **Bank of England independence 1997**; prudence; low income tax; windfall tax, New Deal; long boom; light regulation; PFI. **Social:** **minimum wage 1999**; tax credits; child-poverty pledge; **Sure Start 1998**; NHS spending doubled; academies 2000; tuition fees 1998/2004; civil partnerships 2004; Equality Act 2010. **Constitution:** **devolution 1999; Good Friday Agreement 10 April 1998; HRA 1998**; Lords Act 1999 (92); FOI 2000; London Mayor 2000; Supreme Court 2009. **Foreign:** ethical dimension (Cook); **Kosovo 1999**, Chicago speech; **Sierra Leone 2000**; DfID; Gleneagles 2005; Social Chapter; St Malo; no euro. **Brown 2007–10:** crisis; Climate Change Act 2008; expenses 2009. **v Old Labour:** no nationalisation; unions at arm's length; low tax; business. **v Thatcherism:** kept markets, union laws, low income tax — but minimum wage, tax credits, investment, constitution. **Verdict:** a distinct project on Thatcherite foundations (Hall: "moving nowhere"; Thatcher: "greatest achievement").

R10.2 The War on Terror

9/11 (11 Sept 2001; ~3,000 dead); Bush: "**smoke them out**"; Blair "**shoulder to shoulder**". **Afghanistan:** Oct 2001; Helmand 2006; **457** British dead; combat ended 2014; Taliban back Aug 2021; bin Laden killed 2011. **Iraq:** WMD; dossiers (**45 minutes**; "dodgy"); **Res. 1441**; 1m march (15 Feb 2003); Commons **412–149**, 139 Labour rebels; **Cook resigns**; invasion **20 March 2003**; ~46,000 troops; **no WMD**; Basra to 2009; **179** dead; Kelly; Hutton, Butler; **Chilcot 2016** ("I will be with you, whatever"). **Home:** Terrorism Act 2000; ATCSA 2001 (Belmarsh; Lords 2004); control orders 2005; **90 days defeated 2005; 7/7 2005 (52 dead)**; Prevent. **US relations:** closest since 1945; influence (UN route, road map); "poodle"; Europe split; later Iraq syndrome (Syria 2013). **Critique:** al-Qaeda weakened, plots foiled v Iraq false case, huge deaths, ISIS, Taliban return, torture and rendition, more terror at home.

R10.3 The financial crisis

Causes: US sub-prime; securitisation; UK banks' huge balance sheets; light regulation. **UK:** **Northern Rock run Sept 2007** (nationalised Feb 2008); **Lehman 15 Sept 2008**; Lloyds–HBOS; **rescue 8 Oct 2008** (~£500bn; RBS, Lloyds); rates **0.5%** (Mar 2009); **QE** (£375bn by 2012); VAT 15%; **G20 London** Apr 2009. **Recession:** GDP –6%; unemployment ~2.5–2.7m;

borrowing ~10% GDP. **Labour** (Brown, Darling): Keynesian stimulus, rescue, 50p tax. **Coalition** (Cameron, **Osborne**): **austerity**, VAT 20%, cuts, welfare reform, Universal Credit; bank reform (Vickers ring-fencing; PRA/FCA 2013). **Impact**: Labour defeat 2010; coalition; distrust; protests; riots 2011; UKIP; wage stagnation; food banks; inequality. **Long-term**: productivity puzzle; QE and asset prices; strained services; high debt; safer banks; Brexit and populism.

R10.4 Cameron

Coalition with **Liberal Democrats** (Clegg) 11 May 2010; majority 2015. **Reforms**: austerity; **Universal Credit** (2012), benefit cap; allowance to £11,000; triple lock; auto-enrolment; **National Living Wage 2016**; **academies and free schools**; Gove curriculum; **pupil premium**; fees £9,000; **Health and Social Care Act 2012**; **same-sex marriage 2013**; **Modern Slavery Act 2015**; **0.7% aid law**; Big Society; Leveson; **Fixed-term Parliaments 2011**; **AV referendum 2011 (No)**; **Scottish referendum 2014 (55.3% No)**; **EVEL**; **EU referendum 2016**. **Foreign**: liberal conservatism; China "golden era"; Russia sanctions; **Middle East — Libya 2011** (Res. 1973; Gaddafi; chaos); **Syria** (vote lost 29 Aug 2013; refugees; strikes Dec 2015); **ISIS** strikes 2014–15; **Iran deal 2015**; Saudi arms; Bahrain base; Palestine vote 2014; Afghanistan ended 2014.

R10.5 Brexit

Referendum **23 June 2016: 51.9% Leave**; Scotland, NI Remain; "Take Back Control". May: Article 50 (29 Mar 2017); 2017 election; deal defeated by 230. Johnson: majority 80 (Dec 2019); **left 31 Jan 2020**; TCA; **Windsor Framework 2023**. **Advantages**: sovereignty, no EU contributions, own trade deals (Australia, NZ, CPTPP, India), regulatory freedom (vaccine), end of free movement. **Disadvantages**: trade barriers (OBR: trade –15%, productivity –4%), investment, labour shortages, record net migration anyway, NI and Scotland, lost influence, Erasmus. Opinion turned; **2025 reset**.

R10.6 Diana

Born **1 July 1961**; married Charles **29 July 1981** (750m viewers); William 1982, Harry 1984; **AIDS** (1987), leprosy, homeless, **landmines** (Angola Jan 1997; Ottawa Treaty Dec 1997); separation 1992; **Panorama 1995** ("three of us"); divorce 1996; died **31 Aug 1997**, Paris; "**People's Princess**" (Blair); grief; the Queen criticised; funeral 6 Sept; inquest 2008 (unlawful killing — driver and paparazzi); Dyson 2021.

R10.7 Since 2016 and the big question

May (Grenfell); Johnson (Covid, vaccines, partygate, Ukraine); **Truss 49 days**; **Sunak** first British Asian PM; **Elizabeth II d. 8 Sept 2022**; **Starmer 4 July 2024 (411)**; Chagos, India deal, EU reset, Palestine recognised (2025); Rayner resigns (Sept 2025); **May 2026**: Labour routed, **Plaid** governs Wales, SNP largest in Scotland, **Reform** surges; **Burnham** wins Makerfield (June), **PM 20 July 2026**. **1997–2012: renewal or contradictions?** Renewal:

constitution, peace, rights, services, aid, Cool Britannia, London 2012. Contradictions: English question and SNP; HRA v terror laws; Iraq; Europe without the euro; debt-fuelled boom → crash; Britishness, 7/7, immigration. **Verdict:** real renewal whose contradictions exploded after 2012 (Scotland 2014, Brexit 2016).

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

New Labour renewed Britain's public services and constitution but tied it to America's wars and a fragile financial boom; the crash brought austerity, the austerity years brought Brexit, and Brexit brought a decade of turmoil that ended with Labour back in power in 2024.